



Robin Holly

HEAD TOYMAKER

Fifteen years of toys, and one very quiet smile.

FOR ROBIN HOLLY'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Frost & Fable's head toymaker for fifteen years and the creator of the Jingle Bear, the company's best-selling toy. Known for loving Christmas, plants and the old ways of making things.

COSTUME

Easy: Green apron, reading glasses, a pencil behind the ear.

Go all out: a vintage workshop look: waistcoat, rolled sleeves, round spectacles, a green work apron and a wooden toy in hand.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your boss for 15 years; he gave you your first job
- **Casey Sleigh:** caters every company party; you often chat in the kitchen
- **Alex Snow:** the rival toymaker every Frost & Fable designer loves to grumble about

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Be the warmest, most helpful guest in the room
- Make sure Nick's legacy is remembered
- Find out what's really happening to the company

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You've carved toys in the Snowbury workshop for 15 years. Your Jingle Bear is the best-selling toy Frost & Fable ever made. Everyone knows you love Christmas, plants and the old ways of making things.

YOUR SECRET: YOU KILLED NICK

At about 3:30 you took a new prototype, a dancing nutcracker, to Nick's study. The door was ajar. You heard Nick and Jordan agree to sell the company to MegaMart: the workshop closes on 15 January, and every design you ever made, the Jingle Bear included, now belongs to MegaMart. Nick laughed and said, "Robin's a sentimental fool. The designs belong to the company anyway." You left the nutcracker on the hall table and walked away.

At 4:00 you signed out the greenhouse key "for holly" and cut three foxglove stalks (your grandmother taught you which plants are poisonous). You borrowed a small saucepan and peppermint extract from Casey's kitchen, and in the workshop kitchenette you boiled the foxglove into a "peppermint syrup". You poured it into an antique bottle, tied it with red velvet ribbon and wrote the tag. You had drawn Nick in the Secret Santa, so at 6:45 you put it under the tree as your gift. At 9:00 Nick poured it into his eggnog. After he collapsed you took the bottle and dropped it out of the workshop window into the snow.

You are the killer

Your cover story: you gave Nick a hand-carved wooden reindeer for Secret Santa. You may lie about the crime. Don't confess until Inspector Noel reveals the solution. All night, keep suspicion pointed well away from the workshop, and try to win Best Liar without anyone guessing why.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Be warm and shocked: Nick was "like family". Point out that Jordan handed Nick his mug and Casey made the eggnog. If anyone asks what you gave for Secret Santa, it was the reindeer.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Tell people Nick gave you your first job at 22 and you can't believe he's gone.
- Gossip: Alex Snow shouted "You'll regret this, Frost!" at about 8:00. Make sure everyone has heard.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan why they were shut in the study with Nick all afternoon.
- Ask Casey whether anyone else went near the eggnog bowl before the toast.

MINI TASK

Get at least two people to say out loud that the eggnog could have been tampered with.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: About the key log: you fetched holly for the mantel (there really is holly on the mantel). About the Secret Santa list: "Yes, I drew Nick, and I gave him the reindeer. Someone must have swapped the gifts." Steer suspicion to Morgan, who ran the Secret Santa and also had the greenhouse key.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- If anyone mentions sawdust or varnish near the study, shrug: the whole lodge smells of the workshop.
- Gossip: Morgan holds nearly every key in the lodge and ran the Secret Santa draw.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan why they went to the greenhouse at 6:00.
- Ask Frankie whether deer really get into the greenhouse.

MINI TASK

Privately convince one player that Morgan could have swapped the Secret Santa gifts.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh | ☐ Alex Snow |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: About the reindeer in your drawer: "I wanted to give it to him privately, later." About the bottle: anyone could have thrown it from that window. Keep pushing Morgan and Alex.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- If asked where you were at 9:50: you ran to fetch a blanket for Nick.
- If Casey mentions the saucepan: you borrowed it for gingerbread glue and left it out, so anyone could have used it after.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Alex what they were doing in the corridor at 9:45.
- Ask Charlie who else is missing from the group photo.

MINI TASK

Before voting, persuade at least one detective to accuse someone other than you.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Fill in a ballot like everyone else and accuse someone else. Do not confess until Inspector Noel reads the solution.

PLAYING ROBIN · READ THIS BEFORE ROUND 1

Your manner: Gentle, sentimental and endlessly helpful. Fuss over people, offer to fetch things, and talk about toys the way other people talk about their children.

Lines to try: "Nick gave me my first job. I owe that man everything." "Fifteen years in that workshop. Every toy has a story, you know." "Can I get anyone a mince pie? Keeping busy helps."

If someone accuses you: Look hurt, not angry: "Me? I carve teddy bears. Ask Morgan who ran that Secret Santa."

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
Taylor Star · Hired Santa
Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
Casey Sleigh · Caterer
Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
Nick Frost · the victim



Jordan Tinsel

FINANCE DIRECTOR

The numbers always add up. Almost always.

FOR JORDAN TINSEL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Nick's business partner for ten years and the company's numbers person. You carried Nick's red mug to him at the 9 o'clock toast.

COSTUME

Easy: Sharp suit, tinsel scarf, calculator.
Go all out: a velvet blazer or three-piece suit, a gold tinsel scarf, a pocket watch and a ledger under one arm.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your business partner of ten years
- **Morgan Ivy:** Nick's assistant; you see each other every day
- **Charlie Bell:** always asking you for budget for the newsletter

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Keep company business confidential, whatever happens
- Make sure nobody blames you for carrying the mug
- Find out who was listening at the study door

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You've been Nick's business partner for ten years. You're the numbers person. At the 9:00 toast, you carried Nick's red mug from the kitchen to him. Casey had filled it from the eggnog bowl.

YOUR SECRET

Two years ago you "borrowed" \$20,000 from the company's charity Toy Drive fund to cover a reindeer-farm investment that failed. Nick found out last week. He said you'd repay it from your sale bonus or he'd go to the police. You also spent 3:00 to 5:00 today in the study with Nick, signing the sale of Frost & Fable to MegaMart. Nobody else is supposed to know about the sale yet.

You are innocent

Your alibi: you were in the study with Nick from 3:00 to 5:00, so you couldn't have gone to the greenhouse.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Jordan



Your manner: Brisk, guarded and precise. Check your watch, answer questions with numbers and never volunteer anything you don't have to.

LINES TO TRY

- "I don't deal in rumours. I deal in figures."
- "Company business is confidential. Even tonight."
- "I carried a mug across a room. That's all."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Stay cool: "I was in the study with Nick from three to five. Check the notes."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Admit you carried the mug, but you never opened it and Casey poured it. Keep the sale and the charity fund secret. Ask Alex why they turned up uninvited. Ask Robin what they gave Nick for Secret Santa.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Nick's red "Big Boss" mug was a joke present from the staff years ago. Nobody else ever used it.
- Gossip: Alex Snow arrived uninvited at 7:15 and went straight over to Nick.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Casey who else was in the kitchen just before the toast.
- Ask Charlie whether there's a photo of you handing over the mug.

MINI TASK

Get Casey to confirm, in front of a witness, that Casey filled the mug and you only carried it.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: When your meeting notes are revealed, admit the sale. Add this: at about 3:30 you heard the hall floorboards creak and smelled sawdust and wood varnish, as though someone had been standing outside the door.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Refuse to say the sale price. "That's confidential, even tonight."
- Gossip: this morning Nick said he had "one unpleasant job" left to do before the party.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Quinn what *Toy Trade Weekly* knows about the sale.
- Ask who in the lodge smells of sawdust and wood varnish. Who works with wood all day?

MINI TASK

Find out who was standing outside the study door at about 3:30.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh | ☐ Alex Snow |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: If pressed about money, confess the charity fund. Insist that Nick alive was your only way to repay it quietly. With Nick dead, the sale might fall through.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Say you always meant to repay every cent from your bonus.
- Point out that you were in the study with Nick from 3:00 to 5:00. The meeting notes prove it.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Taylor who they have been texting all night.
- Ask Morgan whether anyone else used Nick's study today.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, walk the room through your afternoon, minute by minute, in under a minute.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Sam Garland

NICK'S NEPHEW OR NIECE

Every mystery writer needs a plot. Tonight, you are in one.

FOR SAM GARLAND'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Nick's only family, and so his heir. A mystery writer who hasn't been published yet. Arrived on the evening train.

COSTUME

Easy: Cozy cardigan, notebook, scarf.
Go all out: literary chic: a chunky cable-knit cardigan, a tartan scarf, a fountain pen and a battered notebook.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your uncle, and your only family
- **Jamie Pudding:** you've heard Jamie and Nick were once a couple
- **Morgan Ivy:** you drew Morgan in the Secret Santa

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Collect material for your next novel from every guest
- Find out what Nick's will says
- Prove you're a writer, not a poisoner

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You're Nick's only family, so you're his heir. You write mystery novels that nobody has published yet. You arrived on the 6:05 train.

YOUR SECRET

You're deep in debt, and last month Nick refused to lend you money ("Get a real job, Sam"). Your notebook is full of research for your novel *Death by Mistletoe*, and that includes notes on poisonous plants. Foxglove is one of them.

You are innocent

Your alibi: your train didn't arrive until 6:05.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

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- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Sam



Your manner: Dramatic, curious and a little broke. Treat the whole night as research: scribble notes, gasp at clues, quote your own unpublished novel.

LINES TO TRY

- "This would make a marvellous chapter nine."
- "Uncle Nick never read a single page I wrote."
- "In my book, the butler did it. Is there a butler?"

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Laugh it off: "Writing about poison isn't the same as using it. I was on a train!"

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Be charming. Ask people whether Nick ever talked about his will. The cardigan by the fire is yours, and so is the notebook page in its pocket. If anyone asks, admit it: it's research for chapter 9, and you're a writer, not a poisoner. You haven't been near the greenhouse.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You arrived on the 6:05 train. Keep that in mind; it will matter later.
- Gossip: you've heard Nick and Jamie were a couple once.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan what happens to the company now Nick is gone.
- Ask Jamie how long they knew Nick, and how it ended.

MINI TASK

Interview three people "for your next novel" and note one suspicious thing each of them says.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Share something you noticed: at the 8:30 Secret Santa opening, when Nick held up a little bottle with a red ribbon and said "Peppermint! Someone knows me!", Robin looked away and went very quiet.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Nick drew you in the Secret Santa. His gift: a book called *How to Get a Real Job*. Laugh it off.
- You gave Morgan a fountain pen. Ask Morgan if they liked it.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan who had the greenhouse key this afternoon.
- Ask Jamie whether Nick said anything about his peppermint gift.

MINI TASK

With one other player, work out from the list who gave Nick the peppermint.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

☐ Robin Holly

☐ Jordan Tinsel

☐ Casey Sleigh

☐ Alex Snow

☐ Morgan Ivy

☐ Taylor Star

☐ Charlie Bell

☐ Frankie Fir

☐ Quinn Mistletoe

☐ Jamie Pudding

☐ Riley Carol

☐ Inspector Noel

Round 3 & notes



Round 3

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Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Admit the debt if pressed. Point out that the gardener's log means the foxglove was cut before 5:00, when you were still on the train.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- In your novel the poisoner is the butler. Real life is never that simple.
- Your train ticket proves you arrived at 6:05.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Frankie whether anything else was disturbed in the greenhouse.
- Ask Alex where they were before 7:15.

MINI TASK

Tell your theory, mystery-novelist style, to two people in under a minute each.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
Taylor Star · Hired Santa
Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
Casey Sleigh · Caterer
Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
Nick Frost · the victim



Casey Sleigh

CATERER

The eggnog was perfect. Wasn't it?

FOR CASEY SLEIGH'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Owner of Sleigh Bells Catering. You made tonight's food and the big bowl of eggnog, and you filled Nick's red mug just before the toast.

COSTUME

Easy: White apron, chef's hat, ladle.

Go all out: a crisp white chef's jacket, a tall toque, a candy-stripe apron and a silver ladle.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your client; you've catered his parties for five years
- **Robin Holly:** a regular visitor to your kitchen
- **Jamie Pudding:** the village baker; friendly competition

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Prove your eggnog is perfectly safe
- Keep your business reputation spotless
- Make sure everyone gets fed, mystery or not

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You run Sleigh Bells Catering. You made tonight's food and the big bowl of eggnog. You filled Nick's red mug from that bowl just before the toast.

YOUR SECRET

Nick never paid last year's \$4,000 catering bill. When you asked, he threatened to tell everyone your food made his guests ill, which wasn't true. You've been furious with him for months.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
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- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Casey



Your manner: Warm, proud and protective of your food. Bustle about with a ladle, top up drinks and take any slight against the eggnog personally.

LINES TO TRY

- "Everyone had the eggnog. Do you feel ill? No? Well then."
- "Five years I've catered these parties. Five years!"
- "Nutmeg, cinnamon, cream. Not a drop of peppermint."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Bristle: "I poured it from the same bowl as everyone else's. Ask anyone."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Defend your eggnog: everyone drank it all night and nobody else is ill. Share what you saw: at 9:00 Nick took a little glass bottle with a red velvet ribbon and poured it into his mug, saying "My Secret Santa knows me!" After he collapsed, the bottle was gone.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Your eggnog recipe uses nutmeg and cinnamon. There is no peppermint in it at all.
- Gossip: Jordan held Nick's mug for a whole minute before handing it over.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan whether they opened or put down the mug on the way.
- Ask everyone whether they drank the eggnog, and whether they feel fine.

MINI TASK

Get at least three guests to say they drank the eggnog and feel perfectly well.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Admit the unpaid bill if asked. Ask Morgan who drew Nick in the Secret Santa.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You've catered for Frost & Fable for five years.
- Gossip: you're not the only person here Nick owed money to, or who owed money to Nick.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jamie whether Nick was ever fair about money.
- Ask Taylor whether Santa saw anyone near the tree with a small bottle.

MINI TASK

Find one other person Nick treated badly over money, and get them to admit it.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Alex Snow |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Remember this now: at about 4:45 Robin came to your kitchen and borrowed a small saucepan and your peppermint extract "for a workshop project". You thought it was for gingerbread glue. You never got the saucepan back.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Your small saucepan has a Sleigh Bells Catering label on the handle.
- You keep peppermint extract for candy canes, never for the eggnog.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Robin what the "workshop project" was.
- Ask Frankie what time the foxgloves were cut.

MINI TASK

Find out where your missing saucepan ended up (check the evidence table).

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Alex Snow

RIVAL TOYMAKER

Uninvited, unbothered, and colder than the snow outside.

FOR ALEX SNOW'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Owner of Snow Toys, Frost & Fable's biggest rival. Nobody invited you. You arrived by taxi at 7:15.

COSTUME

Easy: All white, frosty silver accessories.
Go all out: ice royalty: head-to-toe white and silver, a faux-fur stole and sparkly snowflake jewellery.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your rival for twelve years
- **Riley Carol:** you've met before, through work
- **Charlie Bell:** Frost & Fable's marketing manager; you've chatted at trade fairs

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Find out whether Frost & Fable is really for sale
- Recruit the best talent in the room for Snow Toys
- Leave tonight with your reputation intact

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You run Snow Toys, Frost & Fable's biggest rival. Nobody invited you. You arrived by taxi at 7:15.

YOUR SECRET

Twelve years ago Nick stole your Snowflake Sled design and made a fortune from it. You heard a rumour that Frost & Fable was for sale, and you came tonight to make Nick an offer, or to make a scene. At about 8:00, in front of several guests, you said: "You'll regret this, Frost!"

You are innocent

Your alibi: your taxi picked you up in town at 6:50.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

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- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Alex



Your manner: Icy, elegant and enjoying the drama a little too much. Arch an eyebrow, hand out business cards and never apologise for coming.

LINES TO TRY

- "Uninvited? I prefer 'unexpected'."
- "Nick and I had history. Twelve years of it."
- "Snow Toys: cool toys for warm hearts."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Shrug: "I wanted him ruined, darling, not dead. A dead man can't sign a deal."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Be frosty but polite. Admit you weren't invited. Deny threatening anyone, until someone mentions it.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Gossip: Nick "borrowed" ideas from half the toy trade, not just from you.
- Your company slogan: "Snow Toys: cool toys for warm hearts."

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan, sweetly, whether Frost & Fable is for sale.
- Ask Charlie how much marketing really knows about the company's future.

MINI TASK

Give your "business card" (name, company, slogan) to three guests.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Admit the stolen Snowflake Sled. Say that you wanted Nick ruined, not dead: a dead man can't sign a deal with you.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- If Riley mentions you, admit Riley is writing a jingle for Snow Toys. Keep it short.
- Gossip: you've heard MegaMart wants the designs, not the workshop.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Quinn who has been talking to the press.
- Ask Taylor whether Santa has a second employer tonight.

MINI TASK

Make someone a job offer at Snow Toys, loudly enough for others to hear.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Share this: at about 9:45, while everyone crowded around Nick, you stepped into the corridor for air. You saw someone in a **green apron** at the workshop window, opening it. You couldn't see their face.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Your taxi receipt proves you were picked up in town at 6:50.
- You only stepped into the corridor for a minute, then came straight back.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask who in the lodge was wearing a green apron tonight.
- Ask Riley whether they heard anything from the workshop end of the corridor.

MINI TASK

Find the person in the green apron and ask them, in front of others, where they were at 9:45.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Morgan Ivy

PERSONAL ASSISTANT

You hold the keys, the list and half the secrets in the lodge.

FOR MORGAN IVY'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Nick's personal assistant for six years. You planned tonight's party, ran the Secret Santa draw and hold most of the lodge keys.

COSTUME

Easy: Smart outfit, clipboard, a ring of keys.

Go all out: office polish: a tailored blazer, a silk scarf or tie, statement glasses, a clipboard and a jangling ring of keys.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your boss for six years
- **Frankie Fir:** the gardener; you share the greenhouse keys
- **Jordan Tinsel:** Nick's partner; you drew Jordan in the Secret Santa

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Keep the party running smoothly, whatever happens
- Keep the Secret Santa a secret for as long as you can
- Make sure the truth comes out, and fairly

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You've organised Nick's life for six years. You planned tonight's party and ran the Secret Santa draw, and you keep the list. You hold most of the lodge keys.

YOUR SECRET

This morning Nick told you that you're out of a job in January, because MegaMart has its own assistants. Also, at 6:00 you signed out the greenhouse key to fetch poinsettias for the tables.

You are innocent

The foxglove was cut before 5:00, and you didn't go to the greenhouse until 6:00.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Morgan



Your manner: Efficient, organised and quietly stressed. Jangle your keys, check your clipboard and try to keep the party on schedule, even now.

LINES TO TRY

- "Toast at nine sharp. It started on time. Everything did."
- "The Secret Santa list is confidential, thank you."
- "I have the keys to nearly everything here. That's my job."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Calmly correct the record: "My greenhouse visit was at six. Check the log."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Keep the party calm. Admit you ran the Secret Santa, but don't say who drew whom: "It's a secret!"

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You set the toast for 9:00 sharp, and it started on time.
- Gossip: Alex Snow was not on the guest list. You have no idea how they got past the door.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Taylor what time Santa took up position by the tree.
- Ask Riley what was playing when Nick collapsed.

MINI TASK

Do a head count: find out where three guests were at 9:40, when Nick collapsed, and write it down.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Once the list is revealed, confirm it's genuine and that nobody could have changed it. Mention that at 5:00 the gardener told you some foxgloves had been cut. You assumed deer had got in.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- At 7:00 you checked the gift pile under the tree. It was complete.
- Sam gave you a fountain pen for Secret Santa. Lovely.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Robin what they put under the tree for Nick.
- Ask Frankie whether deer can actually get into the greenhouse.

MINI TASK

Defend your list: get two people to agree that nobody could have changed it.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Admit you were being let go if pressed. Point out that your greenhouse visit was at 6:00, an hour after the foxgloves were found cut.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The poinsettias you fetched at 6:00 are on every table tonight.
- You had the greenhouse key from 6:00 to 6:15 only, as the log shows.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan what Nick said about you in that meeting.
- Ask Charlie whose face is missing from the 9:50 group photo.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, read your own timeline of the evening aloud to the room, in under a minute.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Taylor Star

HIRED SANTA

Ho, ho... who?

FOR TAYLOR STAR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

An actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been by the tree all evening, handing out presents.

COSTUME

Easy: Santa suit, or an elf costume.

Go all out: the full Santa suit with a fluffy beard, or a velvet elf costume with striped stockings and a bell.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** booked you for the party
- **Charlie Bell:** keeps asking you to pose for photos
- **Everyone else:** you've only just met them, ho ho

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Stay in character as Santa all night
- Hear every bit of gossip in the room
- Find out who's been naughty, and who's been nice

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You're an actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been beside the tree all evening.

YOUR SECRET

A MegaMart executive paid you \$200 to report any gossip from the party. You've been texting them all night.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Taylor



Your manner: Jolly, theatrical and nosy. Stay in Santa (or elf) character as long as you can: ho-ho-ho, ask who's been naughty, and keep sneaking looks at your phone.

LINES TO TRY

- "Ho, ho... who's been naughty tonight?"
- "Santa sees everything from beside the tree."
- "Sorry, just checking on the reindeer."
(Check your phone.)

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Stay in character: "Santa? A poisoner? On Christmas Eve? Ho, ho, no!"

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Stay jolly. Admit you were by the tree from 6:30.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Lots of gifts arrived under the tree between 6:30 and 7:00.
- Gossip: when you asked Nick what he wanted for Christmas, he said "a quiet retirement".

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan who booked Santa, and why.
- Ask Alex what they shouted at Nick at about 8:00. You heard it from the tree.

MINI TASK

In character as Santa, ask three people what they want for Christmas. Note any answer that sounds like a motive.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Share what you saw: at about 6:45, while you were adjusting your beard, someone in a **green workshop apron** slipped a small box with a red velvet ribbon under the tree.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The box was small, about the size of a bottle.
- You remember the ribbon clearly: red velvet, tied in a neat bow.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan which gifts under the tree were for Nick.
- Ask Jamie whether Nick had a sweet tooth.

MINI TASK

Give a "naughty or nice" verdict on two suspects, and explain why.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Confess the MegaMart texts if pressed. They show that MegaMart wanted the deal to go through, and a dead Nick puts it at risk.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- MegaMart wanted the sale to go through. Nick dead puts it at risk.
- You keep checking your phone. Somebody will notice.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan what the sale means now that Nick is gone.
- Ask Quinn whether the press already knew about MegaMart.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, read out "Santa's list": who has been naughty tonight (not necessarily the culprit).

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Charlie Bell

MARKETING MANAGER

Every moment captured. Every photo tells a story.

FOR CHARLIE BELL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Frost & Fable's marketing manager. You've been taking photos all night for the company newsletter.

COSTUME

Easy: Bright festive jumper, camera or phone.

Go all out: the loudest Christmas jumper you own (light-up if possible), a vintage camera round your neck and tinsel in your hair.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your boss; he loved being photographed
- **Jordan Tinsel:** controls your budget
- **Alex Snow:** you've chatted at toy fairs

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Get the perfect photo for the newsletter
- Keep your career options open
- Be the one who spots the clue everyone else missed

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You run marketing for Frost & Fable and you've taken photos all night for the company newsletter.

YOUR SECRET

You leaked the sale rumour to Alex Snow last week, hoping Snow Toys would hire you.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Charlie



Your manner: Upbeat, chatty and always ready with a camera. Line people up for photos, talk in newsletter headlines and drop hints that you know things.

LINES TO TRY

- "Hold it! One more for the newsletter."
- "My camera stamps every photo. Times don't lie."
- "Frost & Fable: Thirty Years of Joy. That was the headline."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Wave your camera: "Me? I was behind the lens all night. I'm in none of the photos!"

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Mention your photos. You have one of the toast at 9:00, with Nick holding his red mug.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You also have a photo of the gift pile under the tree at 7:00.
- Gossip: you photographed Alex arguing with Nick at about 8:00.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan for a quote about Nick for the newsletter.
- Ask Alex for a comment: why come uninvited?

MINI TASK

Take (or pretend to take) a "newsletter photo" of three suspects, and ask each where they were at 9:40.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Admit the leak if anyone asks how Alex knew about the sale.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Next week's newsletter headline was going to be "Frost & Fable: 30 Years of Joy".
- Your 9:00 toast photo shows Nick smiling, red mug in hand.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Quinn who their "source" is.
- Ask Riley whether Snow Toys has been hiring lately.

MINI TASK

Find out whether anyone else knew about the sale before today.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Look through your photos: in the 9:50 group shot of the shocked guests, **Robin is missing**, and the red-ribboned bottle no longer sits by Nick's plate.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Your 9:50 photo was taken from by the tree, facing the whole room.
- You're sure of the time: your camera stamps every photo.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask the missing person where they were at 9:50.
- Ask Taylor who was near the tree straight after Nick collapsed.

MINI TASK

Describe your 9:50 photo to two detectives and let them work out who's missing.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Frankie Fir

LODGE GARDENER

You know which flowers are pretty, and which are deadly.

FOR FRANKIE FIR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

You look after Snowbury Lodge's grounds and greenhouse, and you carry your own greenhouse key.

COSTUME

Easy: Flannel shirt, wellies, garden gloves.
Go all out: country-estate gardener: a tweed flat cap or beanie, flannel, wellies and a potted poinsettia under one arm.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** shares the greenhouse key hook with you
- **Robin Holly:** often pops into the greenhouse for greenery
- **Nick Frost:** owned the lodge; rarely noticed your work

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Protect your greenhouse's reputation
- Teach people which plants are dangerous
- Keep your own little side business to yourself

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You look after Snowbury Lodge's grounds and greenhouse, and you have your own greenhouse key.

YOUR SECRET

You've been quietly selling the lodge's prize poinsettias to the village florist.

You are innocent

You were in the village from 3:15 to 4:50, and you have a receipt.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Frankie



Your manner: Down to earth, practical and a bit gruff. Talk plants to anyone who'll listen, wipe imaginary soil off your hands and get prickly about the greenhouse.

LINES TO TRY

- "Foxglove's pretty, and it's deadly. Same as most things."
- "Deer can't get into my greenhouse. I checked."
- "I was in the village. I have the receipt."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Grumble: "I was in the village buying supplies. Ask the shop."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Explain that the greenhouse grows foxglove, which is lovely and very poisonous, and that only someone who knows plants would think of it.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You were in the village from 3:15 to 4:50 buying supplies.
- Gossip: several people borrow the hall key for greenery at Christmas.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Sam how a novelist knows so much about poisonous plants.
- Ask Casey whether anything went missing from the kitchen today.

MINI TASK

Teach two guests the difference: holly has spiky leaves and red berries; foxglove has tall stalks of bell-shaped flowers.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Confirm your log: all fine at 3:00, three foxglove stalks freshly cut at 5:00. You told Morgan.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The cut ends were still wet at 5:00, so they had been cut not long before.
- If Morgan mentions poinsettias going missing, change the subject.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan what they did after you reported the foxglove.
- Ask who signed out the hall key this afternoon.

MINI TASK

With one other player, use the key log to work out who could reach the greenhouse between 3:00 and 5:00.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Add a detail: there was sawdust in the soil by the foxglove bed, and your greenhouse never has sawdust in it.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Sawdust doesn't blow in from outside. Someone carried it in on their clothes.
- Deer cannot get into your greenhouse. You checked the door.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask who in the lodge works with sawdust every day.
- Ask Jordan what they smelled outside the study at 3:30.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, give a 30-second "expert witness" statement about the foxglove to the room.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Quinn Mistletoe

JOURNALIST

Off the record? Nothing is ever off the record.

FOR QUINN MISTLETOE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

You write for *Toy Trade Weekly*, and you came tonight as a guest, "for the egnog".

COSTUME

Easy: Trench coat, press badge.

Go all out: a 1940s newshound: belted trench coat, a fedora with a PRESS card in the band, and a notepad.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** you've interviewed him twice
- **Charlie Bell:** sends you press releases
- **Alex Snow:** a regular in your industry gossip column

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Get an exclusive quote from everyone in the room
- Find the real story behind tonight
- Never reveal a source

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You write for *Toy Trade Weekly*. You came as a guest "for the eggnog".

YOUR SECRET

You're undercover, chasing the story of the MegaMart sale.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Quinn



Your manner: Charming, nosy and always "off the record". Lean in close, write everything down and answer questions with questions.

LINES TO TRY

- "Just a friendly chat. Nothing's on the record. Probably."
- "My source is very good. And very anonymous."
- "Could I get a quote from you about Nick?"

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Smile: "I'm here for the story, not the mug. Journalists don't poison sources."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Ask everyone, casually, whether the company is changing hands.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Gossip: MegaMart has been buying up small toy companies all year.
- Gossip: you've heard Nick and Jamie were a couple once.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan, "off the record", about the company's future.
- Ask Alex what Snow Toys thinks of MegaMart.

MINI TASK

Get an "exclusive quote" from three suspects and write them down for your story.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Reveal what your source told you: the sale contract says **all designs belong to the company**, so the Jingle Bear and every other toy Robin made go to MegaMart. Robin gets nothing.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The sale was signed today at 4:55. Your source is very good.
- Nobody who designed toys for Frost & Fable will own their work after the sale.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan when the staff were going to be told.
- Ask Morgan whether everyone keeps their job.

MINI TASK

Say your front-page headline aloud to the room.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Taylor Star | ☐ Charlie Bell |
| ☐ Frankie Fir | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Admit why you're really here if pressed.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You've been writing everything down all night. Offer your notes to the Inspector.
- If pressed, admit you're here for the MegaMart story.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Taylor who has been paying for gossip tonight.
- Ask Charlie to describe the 9:50 photo for your article.

MINI TASK

Write the first line of your news story in your notes and read it out before ballots.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Jamie Pudding

VILLAGE BAKER

Sweet on the outside, with an old flame on the inside.

FOR JAMIE PUDDING'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

You run Pudding's Bakery in the village, and you brought a tray of gingerbread tonight. You and Nick were a couple once, years ago.

COSTUME

Easy: Flour-dusted apron, gingerbread brooch.

Go all out: a flour-dusted vintage apron, a headscarf, a gingerbread brooch and a plate of biscuits to share.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Nick Frost:** your ex; you parted on bad terms
- **Casey Sleigh:** the caterer; friendly competition
- **Sam Garland:** Nick's heir; you knew Sam as a child

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Find out who really knew Nick best
- Keep your private business private
- Make sure everyone tries your gingerbread

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You run Pudding's Bakery in the village. You and Nick were a couple years ago, and you parted on bad terms.

YOUR SECRET

Nick lent you the money to open the bakery and demanded it back this month.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Jamie



Your manner: Sweet, nostalgic and a little sharp underneath. Press gingerbread on everyone, remember the old days and go quiet whenever Nick's money comes up.

LINES TO TRY

- "Have a gingerbread. Go on, nobody's touched them."
- "I knew Nick before any of you. Long before."
- "He was kind once. Ask the old crew."

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Sigh: "I loved him once. That's not a motive, it's a memory."

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Share a memory: Nick adored peppermint, though only people who'd known him for years knew how much.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You used to bake Nick peppermint bark every Christmas.
- You brought a tray of gingerbread tonight, and nobody's touched it yet.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Sam whether Nick left everything to them.
- Ask Casey whether anything on tonight's menu has peppermint in it.

MINI TASK

Find out who at the party has known Nick for more than five years.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Tell people this: at 8:40 Nick told you, "Someone here really knows me. Peppermint syrup! Must be one of the old crew."

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- "The old crew" means people who've known Nick for years.
- Nick seemed truly touched by the gift. That's rare.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan who drew Nick in the Secret Santa.
- Ask Taylor what gifts went under the tree for Nick.

MINI TASK

Make a list of "the old crew" and share it with one detective.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

☐ Robin Holly

☐ Jordan Tinsel

☐ Sam Garland

☐ Casey Sleigh

☐ Alex Snow

☐ Morgan Ivy

☐ Taylor Star

☐ Charlie Bell

☐ Frankie Fir

☐ Quinn Mistletoe

☐ Riley Carol

☐ Inspector Noel

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Admit the loan if asked.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Nick wanted the bakery loan repaid by New Year's Day.
- You never wished him harm. You just wished he'd been kinder.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Casey whether Nick paid his bills on time.
- Ask Jordan whether the company is in money trouble.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, offer a short toast in Nick's memory.

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

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 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim



Riley Carol

HIRED PIANIST

You play the carols, and you hear everything.

FOR RILEY CAROL'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

Hired to play carols all evening. The piano sits near the corridor to the workshop, so you've had a view of most of the room.

COSTUME

Easy: Bow tie or velvet, sheet music.

Go all out: lounge-pianist glamour: a velvet jacket or dress, a bow tie or pearls, and a folder of carol sheet music.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** booked you for the party
- **Alex Snow:** you've met before, through work
- **Taylor Star:** your fellow hired entertainer

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Keep the music (and the mood) going
- Hear everything without being noticed
- Keep your side job quiet

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

Before the game



You were hired to play carols all evening. The piano sits near the corridor to the workshop.

YOUR SECRET

You're secretly writing a jingle for Snow Toys, Alex's company.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
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- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Riley



Your manner: Dreamy, observant and musical. Hum carols under your breath, take requests and let slip that you notice everything from the piano.

LINES TO TRY

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- | | |
|--|---|
| • "Any requests? I know every carol there is." | • Play it light: "I was at the piano all night. Everyone heard me." |
| • "From the piano you can see the whole room." | |
| • "I stopped playing the moment he fell." | |

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Mention that you could see most of the room from the piano.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You were playing "Silent Night" at the 9:00 toast, and saw Nick pour something from a little bottle into his mug.
- Gossip: you saw headlights at 7:15 when Alex's taxi pulled up.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Charlie which photos were taken near the piano.
- Ask Casey who carried the mug from the kitchen.

MINI TASK

Take carol requests: ask three guests for their favourite carol and what they were doing when Nick collapsed.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Admit you know Alex, if asked.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- From the piano you can see the door to the workshop corridor.
- Gossip: you've heard Snow Toys pays very well.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Alex whether Snow Toys is planning anything big.
- Ask Morgan who has keys to the workshop.

MINI TASK

Find out who left the main room between 9:40 and 9:50.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

☐ Robin Holly

☐ Jordan Tinsel

☐ Sam Garland

☐ Casey Sleigh

☐ Alex Snow

☐ Morgan Ivy

☐ Taylor Star

☐ Charlie Bell

☐ Frankie Fir

☐ Quinn Mistletoe

☐ Jamie Pudding

☐ Inspector Noel

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Share this: at about 9:45, just after Nick collapsed, you heard a window creak open at the workshop end of the corridor, and footsteps hurrying back.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- You stopped playing the moment Nick fell, and that's when you heard the window.
- The footsteps came back towards the main room, quickly.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Alex what they saw in the corridor.
- Ask who walked back in from the corridor just before 9:50.

MINI TASK

Hum a carol to set the mood as ballots are filled in. Stay in character!

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

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